L3 LEA · S6 ELODIE GALLET

Compréhension et expression anglaises

Listening and Speaking in English: a Printable Workbook

VERSION EXPRESS · UN EXERCICE D'APPLICATION PAR CHAPITRE

3 · 3 EXERCISES

Exercices rédigés pour l'application à partir des fiches du cours ; les situations marquées « fictive » sont inventées. En cas de différence avec le cours de l'enseignant, c'est le cours qui fait foi.

PART 1

Spoken English: weak forms, connected speech and accents

EXERCISE 1.1 APPLICATION FICTIONAL SITUATION

Decoding connected speech

Objective : *Be able to recognise written words behind connected speech and name the phenomenon (linking, linking R, assimilation, elision, informal contraction).*

A trainee wrote down, as she heard them, six extracts from a meeting with a British supplier. Her notes are in the left column; find the written words and name the phenomenon.

EXTRACT	WHAT THE TRAINEE HEARD	WRITTEN WORDS	PHENOMENON
1	/dɪdʒuː/ get the invoice?		
2	Can you /pɪkɪtʌp/ tomorrow?		
3	We'll /lɑːs wiːk/ … no, we did it last week.		
4	It's /fɑːrəweɪ/ from the port.		
5	We're /ˈgʌnə/ need more pallets.		
6	The fee is /tem paʊndz/ per box.		

Questions

1. Complete the table: written words and phenomenon for each extract.
2. Which of these forms must never appear in a professional e-mail, and how should it be written?
3. Why does the trainee hear /tem/ instead of /ten/ in extract 6?

PART 2

Listening method: listening in stages, note-taking, reporting

EXERCISE 2.1 APPLICATION FICTIONAL SITUATION

Listening in stages to a radio interview

Objective : *Apply the three listening stages to a transcript and pick out key information and discourse markers.*

Transcript (read it aloud three times, as if you were listening three times). Title: 'Small producers go global'. PRESENTER: Good morning. With me today is Laura Kemp, who runs Kemp Teas, a family business in Kent. Laura, you started exporting three years ago. Why? KEMP: Well, the home market was saturated. So we looked abroad, first to Germany and then to Japan. PRESENTER: And was it easy? KEMP: Not at all. The paperwork was a nightmare. However, we got help from a regional export agency, and that made all the difference. Today forty per cent of our turnover comes from exports. PRESENTER: Forty per cent! What advice would you give to other small firms? KEMP: Start with one market, learn its rules, and visit your customers. Because, in the end, trade is about trust.

Questions

1. Global listening: type of document, speakers, topic, tone.
2. What are the three main ideas of the interview?
3. List the details: countries, figures, sources of help, three pieces of advice.
4. Find four connectors and give their function. Which one tells you that a difficulty is followed by a solution?
5. Take notes on the whole interview in three columns (topic / ideas / details).

PART 3

Speaking: presentations and interaction

EXERCISE 3.1 APPLICATION FICTIONAL SITUATION

Preparing a three-minute presentation

Objective : *Build the plan and the key sentences of a short professional presentation from a set of notes.*

You are an intern at Atlantic Foods (an invented company). Your manager asks you to present, in English, the results of a market study on Mexico to the sales team. Your notes: - Market: growing demand for imported cheese, mainly in large cities. - Competition: two European exporters already present; prices higher than ours. - Chart prepared: monthly imports of cheese, rising since 2023. - Recommendation: test the market with one distributor in Mexico City.

Questions

1. Write the outline in three parts.
2. Write the opening (3 to 4 sentences).
3. Write the two transitions and the sentence about the chart.
4. Write the conclusion (2 to 3 sentences).
5. Why should you not write the whole speech on your slides?

Explained answer key

Exercise 1.1 · Decoding connected speech

1. 1. (1) Did you get the invoice? Assimilation: /d/ + /j/ merge into /dʒ/. (2) pick it up: linking, the final consonants k and t join the following vowels, so three words sound like one. (3) last week: elision, the /t/ of last disappears between /s/ and /w/. (4) far away: linking R, typical of British English; the r of far, silent before a consonant, is pronounced because a vowel follows. (5) going to: informal contraction gonna. (6) ten pounds: assimilation, /n/ becomes /m/ before /p/.
2. 2. Gonna must never be written in a professional document: write We are going to need more pallets (or We will need). The course rule is: recognise gonna, wanna, gotta when you hear them, but avoid them in professional writing.
3. 3. Because of assimilation: /n/ is pronounced with the tongue, /p/ with the lips; to save effort, the speaker already closes the lips, which turns /n/ into /m/. The listener must mentally restore ten. Final result: connected speech changes the sounds, not the words; knowing the five phenomena lets you rebuild the words.

Traps to avoid : Confusing elision (a sound disappears) with assimilation (a sound changes). · Expecting a linking R in American English in the same way: the course presents it as a feature of British English. · Writing gonna or wanna in a report or an e-mail.

Exercise 2.1 · Listening in stages to a radio interview

1. 1. Type: radio interview (a presenter asks questions, a guest answers). Speakers: the presenter and Laura Kemp, head of Kemp Teas, a family business in Kent. Topic: how a small firm started exporting. Tone: positive, encouraging, with a realistic note about difficulties.
2. 2. (1) Why they exported: the home market was saturated. (2) The difficulties and how they were overcome: paperwork, help from a regional export agency. (3) Results and advice: 40% of turnover from exports; advice to other small firms. The structure follows the presenter's three questions.
3. 3. Countries: Germany first, then Japan. Figures: three years ago; forty per cent of turnover. Help: a regional export agency. Advice: start with one market, learn its rules, visit your customers (because trade is about trust).
4. 4. So (consequence: saturated market, therefore exports); first … then (sequence: Germany before Japan); however (contrast: the difficulty, then the solution); because (cause: why customers must be visited). However is the marker that announces the turn from problem to solution: after it, listen very carefully, because the important information often follows a contrast connector.
5. 5. Possible notes. Topic: Kemp Teas (family co., Kent), exports since 3 yrs. Ideas: home mkt saturated → export (1. Germany, 2. Japan) | paperwork = nightmare ≠ help regional export agency | 40% turnover = exports. Details / advice: 1 mkt, learn rules, visit customers b/c trade = trust. Final result: three listenings, each with a different goal, give a complete and organised picture without transcribing every word.

Traps to avoid : Trying to understand everything at the first listening instead of first identifying the situation. · Writing Kemp Teas exports 40% of its products: the figure concerns turnover, not volume. Note figures with what they measure. · Ignoring however: you then miss the solution to the problem.

Exercise 3.1 · Preparing a three-minute presentation

1. 1. Part 1: the Mexican market (growing demand). Part 2: the competition (two European exporters, higher prices). Part 3: recommendation (test with one distributor in Mexico City). The order goes from facts to analysis to action.
2. 2. Model: Good morning, everyone. My name is … and I'm an intern in the export department. The purpose of this presentation is to share the results of our market study on Mexico. First, I'll give you an overview of the market; then I'll look at the competition; finally, I'll make a recommendation.
3. 3. Chart: As you can see on this chart, imports of cheese have risen steadily since 2023. Transitions: Let's now turn to the competition. / This brings me to my recommendation. Using two different expressions avoids repetition and clearly marks each change of part.
4. 4. Model: To sum up, demand is growing and our prices are lower than those of our two main competitors. I'd recommend that we test the market with one distributor in Mexico City. Thank you for your attention; I'd be happy to answer any questions.
5. 5. Slides support the talk; they do not replace it. If everything is written, the audience reads instead of listening, and you are tempted to read aloud instead of looking at them. Final result: a clear outline, signposting at every step and a conclusion that leads to action make a professional presentation.

Traps to avoid : Announcing an outline and then not following it. · Describing the chart without saying what it means for the company. · Ending abruptly without a summary or an invitation to ask questions.

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